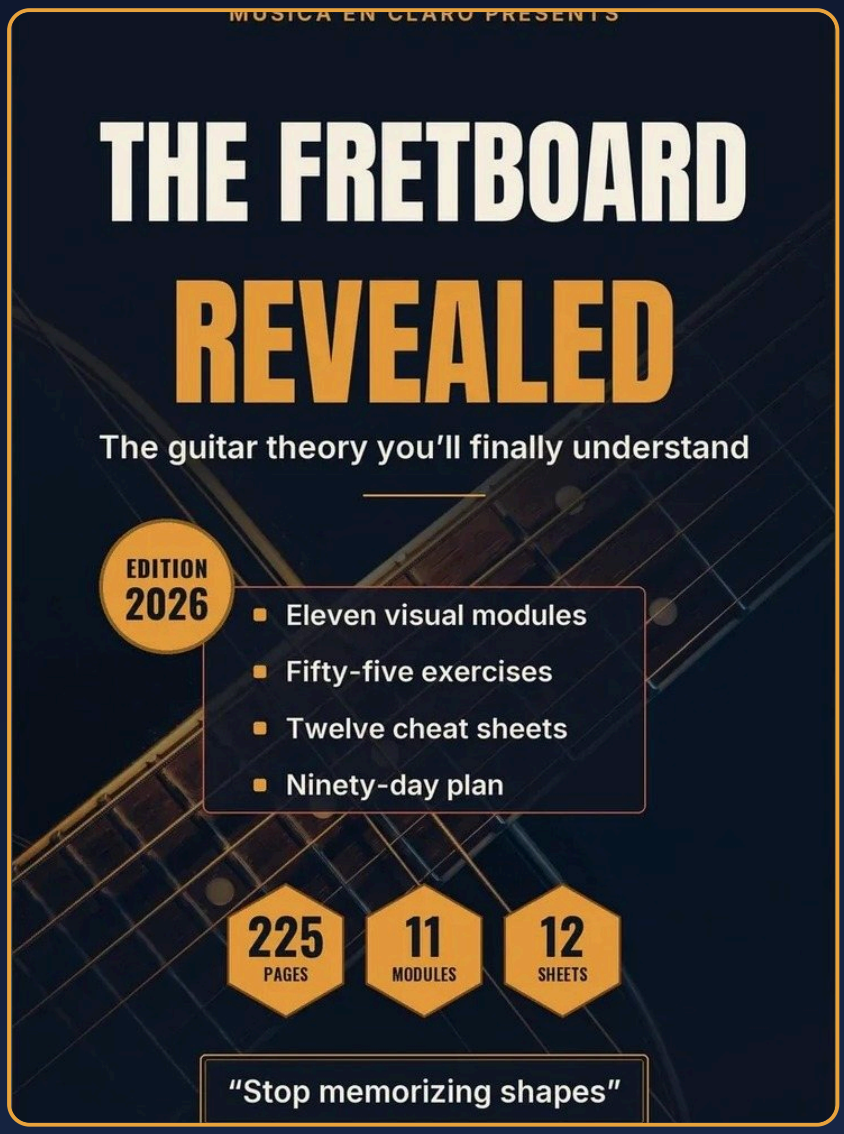
BONUS 2

The 12 Cheat Sheets

High resolution, A4 and A2 poster

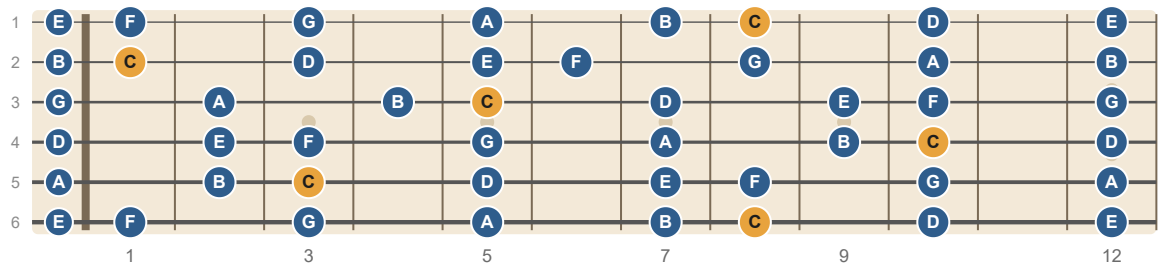


Sheet 1: The Notes on the Neck

Three anchors and octave shapes

You do not need to memorize 72 spots. Learn three anchors and two or three shapes, and every fret becomes a note you can work out in seconds.

Natural notes, frets 0 to 12



The 12th fret repeats the open strings one octave higher.

The three anchors

Strings 6, 5, 4 (E, A, D): your three anchor strings. Name the open string, then count up from it.
Fret 12 is the same note as the open string, one octave up.
Natural notes (no sharps or flats) sit a whole step apart, except E to F and B to C, which are a half step (one fret).

Octave shapes (same note name, higher pitch)

FROM STRING	TO STRING	MOVE	EXAMPLE
6	4	up 2 frets	A on 6th string, fret 5 = A on 4th string, fret 7
5	3	up 2 frets	C on 5th string, fret 3 = C on 3rd string, fret 5
4	2	up 3 frets	D on 4th string, fret 0 = D on 2nd string, fret 3
3	1	up 3 frets	G on 3rd string, fret 0 = G on 1st string, fret 3

Same note on neighboring strings

Going from one string to the next lower-sounding string, the same note is **5 frets higher** (for example, E at fret 0 on string 6 is also fret 5 on string 5). The one exception is between strings 3 and 2: there it is **4 frets**.

Quick check

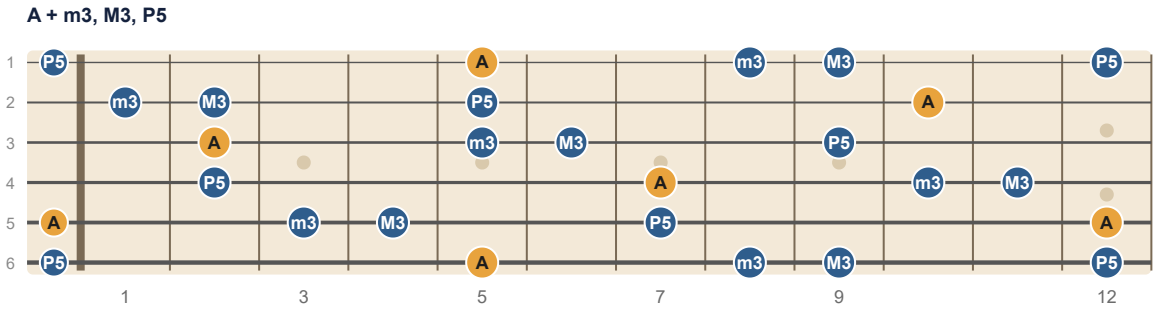
Find F on the 6th string (fret 1). Use the octave shape to find the next F on the 4th string (fret 3).

Sheet 2: Intervals

Name, semitones and feel

An interval is the distance between two notes. One fret equals one semitone (half step). Learn the sound and the number of frets, and you can build anything.

INTERVAL	NAME	SEMITONES	FEEL
P1	Unison	0	Same note
m2	Minor 2nd	1	Tense, close, uneasy
M2	Major 2nd	2	A step: open, neutral
m3	Minor 3rd	3	Sad, dark, soft
M3	Major 3rd	4	Bright, happy
P4	Perfect 4th	5	Open, hanging
b5	Tritone	6	Unstable, wants to move
P5	Perfect 5th	7	Strong, stable, empty
m6	Minor 6th	8	Bittersweet
M6	Major 6th	9	Warm, sweet
m7	Minor 7th	10	Bluesy, unresolved
M7	Major 7th	11	Dreamy, leaning to resolve
P8	Octave	12	Same note, higher



Intervals above A: minor 3rd (C), major 3rd (C#) and perfect 5th (E).

The shortcut

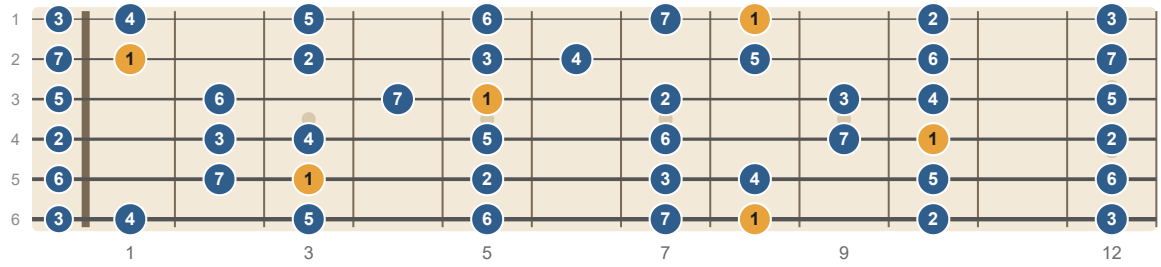
Major or minor? The 3rd decides. A major 3rd is 4 frets above the root, a minor 3rd is 3 frets. Everything else in a basic chord stays the same.

Sheet 3: The Major Scale and the Keys

One formula, twelve keys

Whole step, whole step, half step, whole, whole, whole, half. Start on any note, follow the formula, and you have a major scale. **Formula:** W W H W W W H (W = 2 frets, H = 1 fret). **Degrees:** 1 2 3 4 5 6 7.

C major



C major across the neck: C D E F G A B.

KEY	SHARPS / FLATS	NOTES
C	none	C D E F G A B
G	1 #	G A B C D E F#
D	2 #	D E F# G A B C#
A	3 #	A B C# D E F# G#
E	4 #	E F# G# A B C# D#
B	5 #	B C# D# E F# G# A#
F# (Gb)	6 # (6 b)	F# G# A# B C# D# E#
Db	5 b	Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb C
Ab	4 b	Ab Bb C Db Eb F G
Eb	3 b	Eb F G Ab Bb C D
Bb	2 b	Bb C D Eb F G A
F	1 b	F G A Bb C D E

Master rule

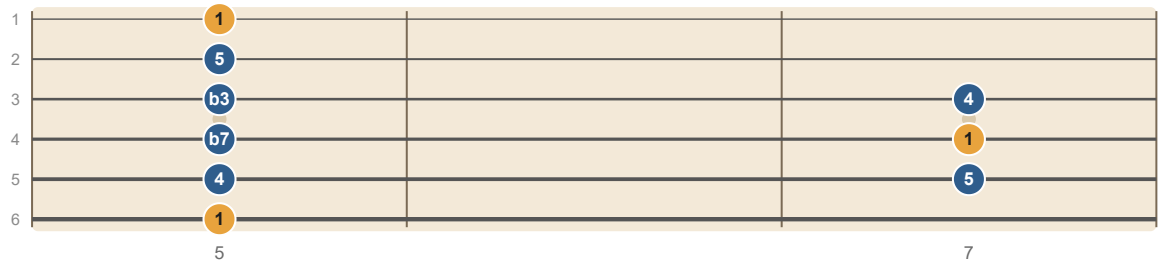
Every major key uses each letter name once. That is why the key of F# has E# (not F) and the key of Db has Gb (not F#).

Sheet 4: Pentatonic and Blues Boxes

A minor pentatonic in 5 positions

Five notes, five boxes, the whole neck. The minor pentatonic is the safest first scale for soloing.
Minor pentatonic formula: 1 b3 4 5 b7. In A minor: A C D E G. **Blues scale:** add the b5 (Eb) to get 1 b3 4 b5 5 b7: A C D Eb E G.

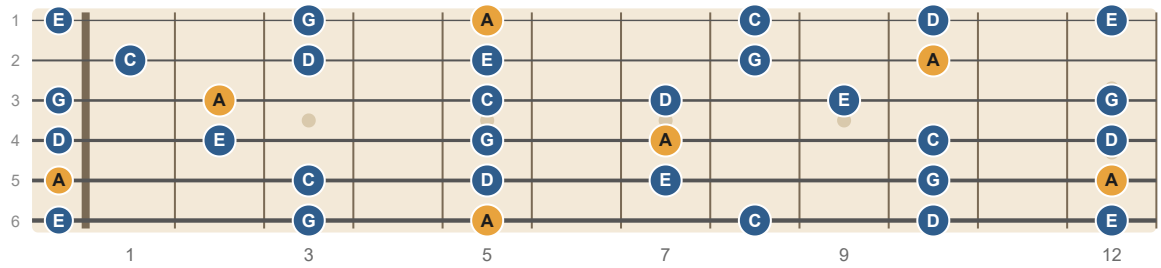
A minor pentatonic



Position 1 (frets 5 to 8): the home box. The root A (degree 1) is on strings 6 and 1 at fret 5 and on string 4 at fret 7.

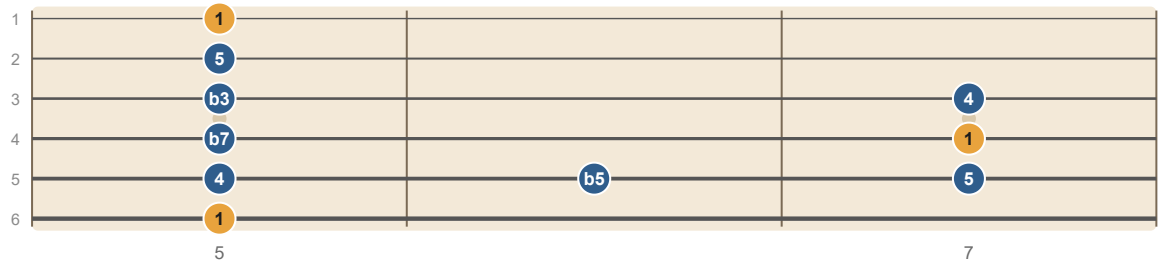
POSITION	FRETS (A MINOR)	NOTES
1	5 - 8	Home box, root on 6th string fret 5
2	7 - 10	Slides up from box 1; overlaps it at frets 7 and 8
3	9 - 12	Middle of the neck
4	12 - 15	Continues up the neck
5	14 - 17 (or 2 - 5)	Connects back to box 1 at fret 17 (fret 5)

A minor pentatonic



All five positions at once, frets 0 to 12.

A blues



A blues box 1: the same box plus the b5.

Tip

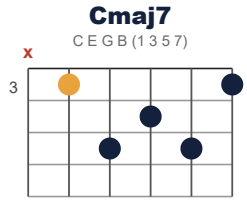
Every box repeats at the 12th fret. Learn box 1 first, then add one box a week.

Sheet 5: Chord Types

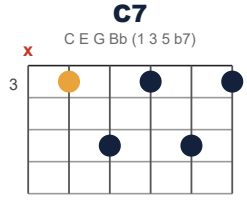
Formulas and notes (all examples on C)

Chords are stacked notes from the major scale (1 2 3 4 5 6 7). Learn the formula and you can spell any chord in any key.

TYPE	SYMBOL	FORMULA	NOTES IN C
Major	C	1 3 5	C E G
Minor	Cm	1 b3 5	C Eb G
Diminished	Cdim	1 b3 b5	C Eb Gb
Augmented	Caug	1 3 #5	C E G#
Suspended 2	Csus2	1 2 5	C D G
Suspended 4	Csus4	1 4 5	C F G
Sixth	C6	1 3 5 6	C E G A
Dominant 7	C7	1 3 5 b7	C E G Bb
Major 7	Cmaj7	1 3 5 7	C E G B
Minor 7	Cm7	1 b3 5 b7	C Eb G Bb
Half-diminished	Cm7b5	1 b3 b5 b7	C Eb Gb Bb
Diminished 7	Cdim7	1 b3 b5 bb7	C Eb Gb Bbb (A)
Add 9	Cadd9	1 3 5 9	C E G D
Dominant 9	C9	1 3 5 b7 9	C E G Bb D



Cmaj7, A-shape (root on the 5th string, fret 3).



C7, A-shape: lower the 7th by one fret (maj7 to 7).

Remember

The 9th is the same note as the 2nd, one octave higher. A 2 and a 9 are the same letter name.

Sheet 6: Harmonizing the Major Scale

Triads and sevenths in six keys

Build a chord on each note of the major scale using only notes from that scale. The qualities always come out the same way in every key.
Triads: I major, ii minor, iii minor, IV major, V major, vi minor, vii diminished. **Sevenths:** Imaj7, ii7, iii7, IVmaj7, V7, vi7, vii m7b5.

KEY	I	II	III	IV	V	VI	VII DIM
C	C	Dm	Em	F	G	Am	Bdim
G	G	Am	Bm	C	D	Em	F#dim
D	D	Em	F#m	G	A	Bm	C#dim
A	A	Bm	C#m	D	E	F#m	G#dim
E	E	F#m	G#m	A	B	C#m	D#dim
F	F	Gm	Am	Bb	C	Dm	Edim

KEY	IMAJ7	II7	III7	IVMAJ7	V7	VI7	VII M7B5
C	Cmaj7	Dm7	Em7	Fmaj7	G7	Am7	Bm7b5
G	Gmaj7	Am7	Bm7	Cmaj7	D7	Em7	F#m7b5
D	Dmaj7	Em7	F#m7	Gmaj7	A7	Bm7	C#m7b5
A	Amaj7	Bm7	C#m7	Dmaj7	E7	F#m7	G#m7b5
E	Emaj7	F#m7	G#m7	Amaj7	B7	C#m7	D#m7b5
F	Fmaj7	Gm7	Am7	Bbmaj7	C7	Dm7	Em7b5

Pattern

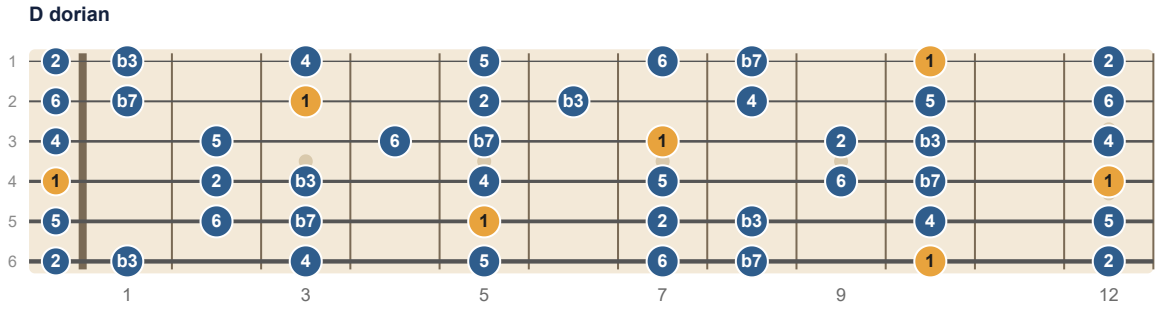
Capital Roman numerals are major chords, lowercase are minor. The I, IV and V chords are the three main chords of the key; the others are the colors.

Sheet 7: The Seven Modes

Formula and feel

A mode is the same seven notes with a different home note. Think of each as a color, not a new scale to memorize.

MODE	FORMULA	IN C-BASED EXAMPLE	FEEL
Ionian (major)	1 2 3 4 5 6 7	C major from C	Bright, happy, settled
Dorian	1 2 b3 4 5 6 b7	D to D, C major notes	Minor with a lift, funky or jazzy
Phrygian	1 b2 b3 4 5 b6 b7	E to E	Dark, tense, Spanish
Lydian	1 2 3 #4 5 6 7	F to F	Dreamy, floating
Mixolydian	1 2 3 4 5 6 b7	G to G	Bluesy, relaxed, rock
Aeolian (natural minor)	1 2 b3 4 5 b6 b7	A to A	Sad, serious
Locrian	1 b2 b3 4 b5 b6 b7	B to B	Unstable, rarely a home



D Dorian: D E F G A B C. Same notes as C major, starting on D.

Parent scale trick

To play a mode of a given root, find the major scale it belongs to. D Dorian is the 2nd mode of C major, so use C major notes and make D home. The next modes follow: E Phrygian, F Lydian, G Mixolydian, A Aeolian, B Locrian.

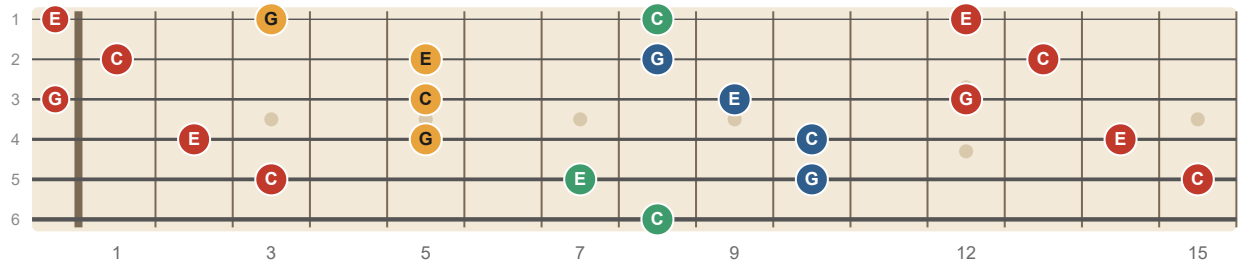
Sheet 8: CAGED

The five shapes and the order

Five open chord shapes - C, A, G, E and D - can be moved up the neck. Together they cover the whole fretboard, and they link end to end in a fixed order.
Order, going up the neck: C, A, G, E, D, then back to C one octave higher. Each shape ends where the next begins.

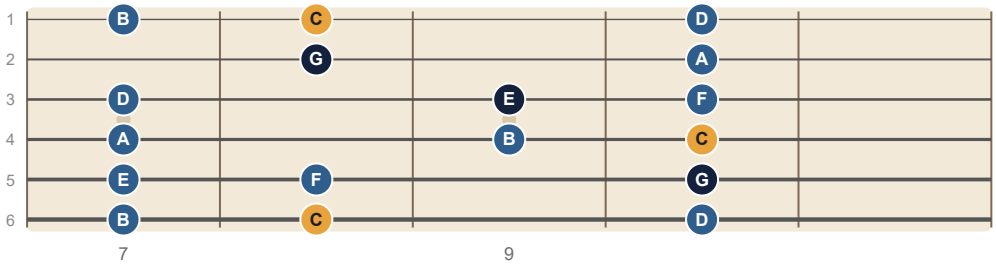
SHAPE	ROOT STRING	FRETS FOR C MAJOR	ROOT NOTE
C	5	0 - 3	Fret 3, string 5
A	5	3 - 5	Fret 3, string 5 (barre)
G	6	5 - 8	Fret 8, string 6
E	6	8 - 10	Fret 8, string 6 (barre)
D	4	10 - 13	Fret 10, string 4

Key of C: the five CAGED shapes (colors: C red, A orange, G green, E blue, D purple)



All five CAGED shapes for C major, chained across the neck.

C major, E-shape (chord tones dark, root orange, other scale notes blue)



The E shape in C major: barre at fret 8.

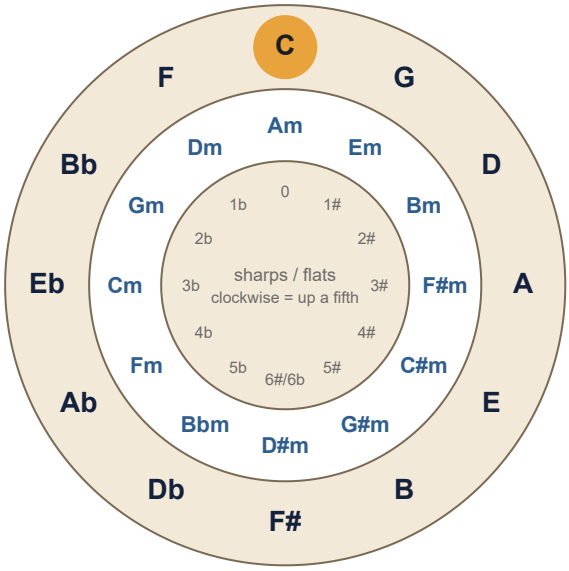
How to use it

Pick a key and find its root on string 6, 5 or 4. That root tells you which shape you are in. Play the notes of the scale around the shape, then jump to the next shape in the order.

Sheet 9: Circle of Fifths

Keys, relatives and key signatures

Moving clockwise goes up a fifth and adds one sharp. Moving counter-clockwise goes up a fourth and adds one flat.



The circle of fifths with C major highlighted.

MAJOR KEY	RELATIVE MINOR	KEY SIGNATURE
C	Am	none
G	Em	1 # (F#)
D	Bm	2 # (F# C#)
A	F#m	3 #
E	C#m	4 #
B	G#m	5 #
F# / Gb	D#m / Ebm	6 # / 6 b
Db	Bbm	5 b
Ab	Fm	4 b
Eb	Cm	3 b
Bb	Gm	2 b
F	Dm	1 b (Bb)

Order of sharps: F C G D A E B.
Order of flats: B E A D G C F.
Neighbors: a key's IV and V chords are the keys on either side of it. In C, those are F (IV) and G (V).
Relative minor: the 6th degree of the major scale, 3 frets below the major root.

Sheet 10: Progressions and Roman Numerals

The top 10 progressions and a transposition table

Roman numerals describe a progression for any key. Learn a pattern once, and you can play it anywhere by looking up the numbers.

#	PROGRESSION	IN C
1	I - V - vi - IV	C - G - Am - F
2	I - IV - V	C - F - G
3	I - vi - IV - V	C - Am - F - G
4	vi - IV - I - V	Am - F - C - G
5	ii - V - I	Dm7 - G7 - Cmaj7
6	I - IV - I - V	C - F - C - G
7	12-bar blues: I7 - IV7 - V7	C7 - F7 - G7
8	I - bVII - IV	C - Bb - F
9	i - bVII - bVI - bVII (minor)	Am - G - F - G
10	i - iv - V (minor)	Am - Dm - E

Transposition table

I	IV	V	VI
C	F	G	Am
Db	Gb	Ab	Bbm
D	G	A	Bm
Eb	Ab	Bb	Cm
E	A	B	C#m
F	Bb	C	Dm
F#	B	C#	D#m
G	C	D	Em
Ab	Db	Eb	Fm
A	D	E	F#m
Bb	Eb	F	Gm
B	E	F#	G#m

Tip

To transpose, find the I chord in the first column and read across.

Sheet 11: Improvising Checklist

Three questions, targets and phrasing

Improvising is not random. Ask three questions before and during every solo.

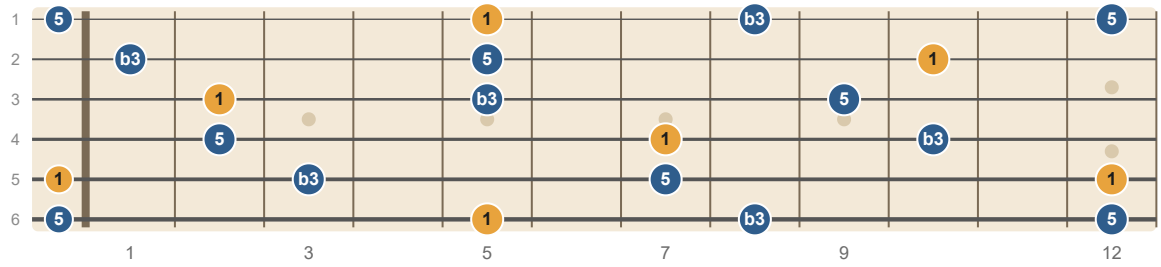
The three questions

☐ Where is home? Which key or scale fits the song?
☐ Which chord is playing right now? What are its 1, 3 and 5?
☐ Where do I want to land? Pick the target note before you play.

Targets

Chord tones (1, 3, 5) are the safest landing notes, especially on strong beats.
The **3rd** tells the listener whether the chord is major or minor: land on it to show the change.
Passing notes (everything else in the scale) work best between targets, on weak beats.
Resolve tense notes (b5, 4, 7) by moving one fret or one scale step to a stable note.

Targets over an Am chord: A, C, E



The chord tones of Am across the neck. Aim for these.

Phrasing

Play a short idea, then rest. Silence is part of the phrase.
Repeat an idea, then change one thing (rhythm, last note, or octave).
Start and finish on a target. Sing it in your head first.

Sheet 12: Practice Routine

A 10-minute daily session and a weekly plan

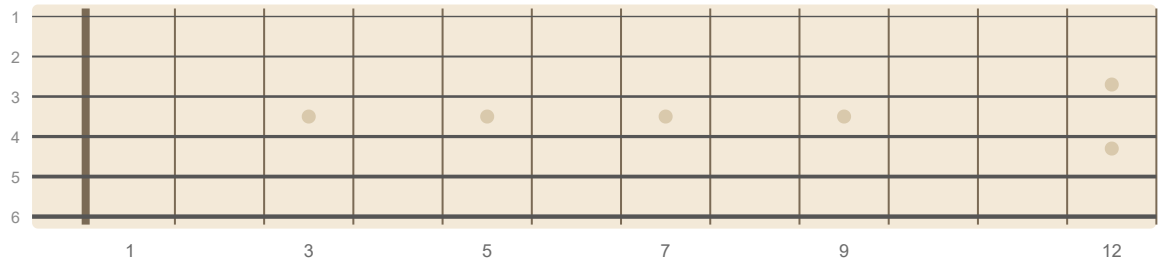
Ten focused minutes beat an hour of drifting. Use the same template every day and rotate the topic.

The 10-minute session

MINUTES	BLOCK	WHAT TO DO
1	Warm up	Name the notes on one string, up and down, out loud.
2	See	Play one box, scale or CAGED shape in the key of the day, saying the degrees.
2	Build	Spell the chords of that key, then play I - IV - V - vi.
3	Create	Improvise over a backing track or your own chords with one target note per bar.
2	Review	Repeat the one thing that was shaky. Write down the key and one new idea.

The weekly plan

DAY	FOCUS
Mon	Notes on the neck and octave shapes
Tue	Major scale and one new key
Wed	Pentatonic box of the week
Thu	Chords and Roman numerals
Fri	CAGED shape or mode
Sat	Improvise over a progression
Sun	Play a song by ear or rest



Blank neck: fill in all the natural notes from memory, then check against Sheet 1.

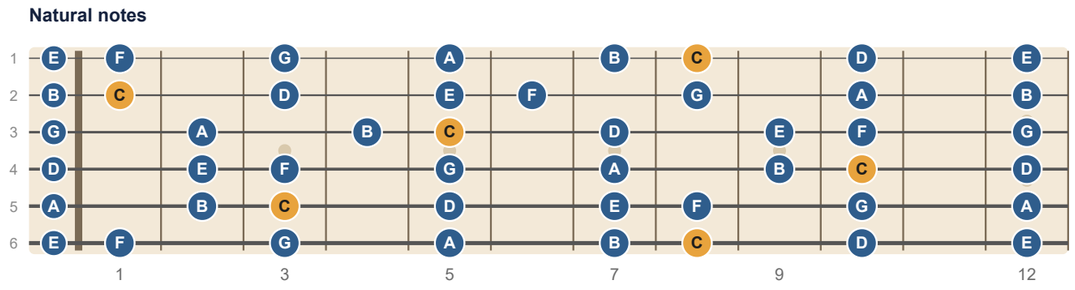
Next step

Pick tomorrow's key, set a timer for 10 minutes and run the template. Most players find that a short daily habit sticks better than an occasional long session.

The Fretboard Map

The Fretboard Revealed - poster edition

The Notes on the Whole Neck



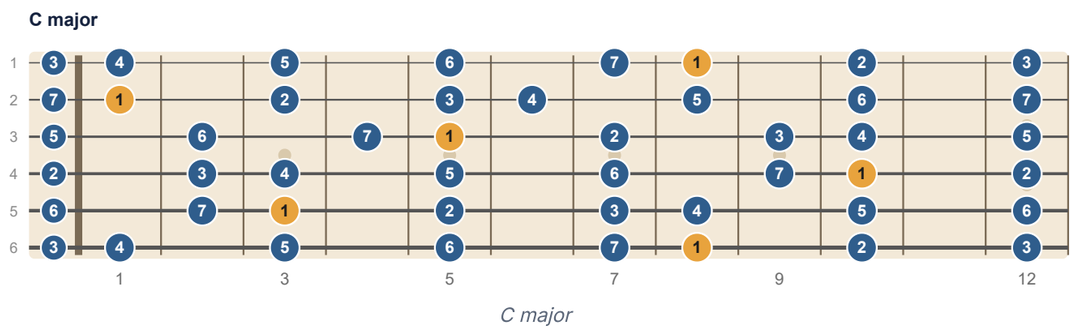
Fret 12 = fret 0 (one octave up). Sharps and flats sit between the notes, one fret apart; E-F and B-C have no note between them.

Intervals

FRETS	INTERVAL	FEEL
1	m2	Tense
2	M2	Step
3	m3	Sad
4	M3	Bright
5	P4	Open
6	b5	Unstable
7	P5	Strong
8	m6	Bittersweet
9	M6	Sweet
10	m7	Bluesy
11	M7	Dreamy
12	P8	Octave

Major Scale Formula

W W H W W W H - degrees 1 2 3 4 5 6 7

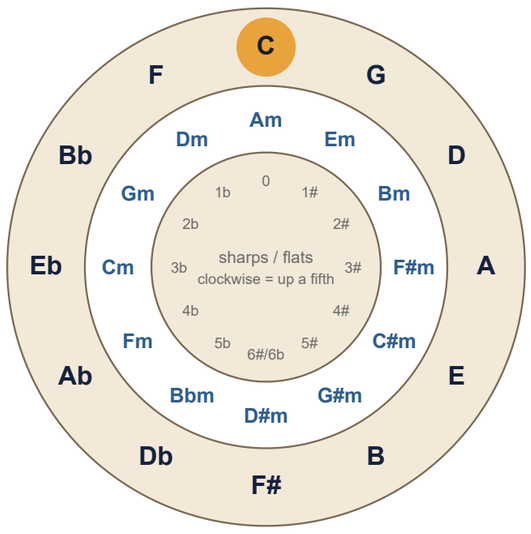


C major

Chord Formulas

CHORD	FORMULA
Major	1 3 5
Minor	1 b3 5
Diminished	1 b3 b5
Augmented	1 3 #5
Sus2	1 2 5
Sus4	1 4 5
Dominant 7	1 3 5 b7
Major 7	1 3 5 7
Minor 7	1 b3 5 b7
Minor 7 b5	1 b3 b5 b7

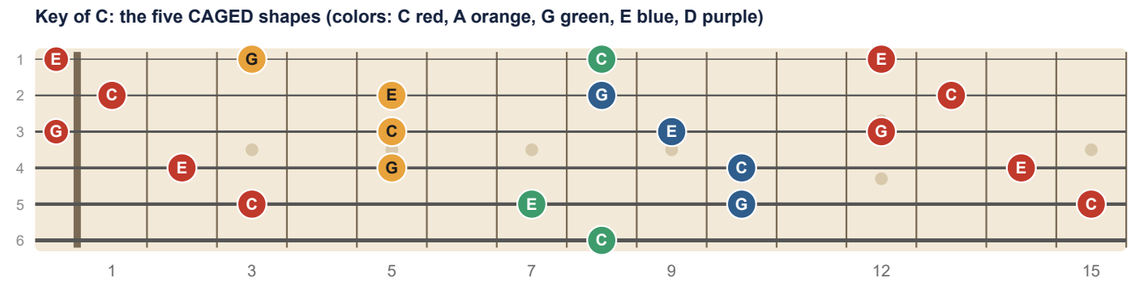
Circle of Fifths



Clockwise: up a fifth, one more sharp. Counter-clockwise: one more flat.

CAGED Order

C - A - G - E - D, then back to C.



The five shapes for C major

The Modes

MODE	FORMULA	FEEL
Ionian	1 2 3 4 5 6 7	Bright
Dorian	1 2 b3 4 5 6 b7	Minor, lifted
Phrygian	1 b2 b3 4 5 b6 b7	Dark
Lydian	1 2 3 #4 5 6 7	Dreamy
Mixolydian	1 2 3 4 5 6 b7	Bluesy
Aeolian	1 2 b3 4 5 b6 b7	Sad
Locrian	1 b2 b3 4 b5 b6 b7	Unstable

Legend

SYMBOL	MEANING
Highlighted dot	Root note
Other dots	Notes of the scale or chord
Number in dot	Degree: 1 b3 5 ...
Strings	6 = low E, 1 = high E
Fret 0	Open string
b / #	Flat = one fret down, sharp = one fret up